

GNOME + macOS Tahoe Theme Setup Guide

EndeavourOS / Arch Linux · Step-by-Step · ADHD Edition

One step at a time. One command at a time. No fluff.

■ PHASE 1 — PREPARE YOUR SYSTEM

[1.1] Remove the pacman lock (if it exists)

If pacman was interrupted before, a lock file may remain. Remove it:

```
sudo rm /var/lib/pacman/db.lck
```

■ Only run this if pacman gives a 'lock file exists' error.

[1.2] Install all required dependencies

This installs the tools needed for theme building and GNOME config:

```
sudo pacman -S gcc make cmake git curl wget wmctrl sassc gnome-tweaks
```

■ Press Y and Enter when prompted to confirm.

[1.3] Install GNOME desktop environment

This installs GNOME alongside your existing desktop (e.g. Hyprland):

```
sudo pacman -S gnome gnome-extra
```

■ This downloads a lot. Takes 5–15 minutes depending on your internet.

[1.4] Switch login manager to GDM

Disable SDDM (Hyprland's login manager) and enable GDM (GNOME's):

```
sudo systemctl disable sddm
```

```
sudo systemctl enable gdm
```

■ At login, click the gear icon and select GNOME before signing in.

[1.5] Reboot

```
reboot
```

Log in to GNOME session. Continue from here.

■ PHASE 2 — INSTALL EXTENSIONS

[2.1] Install Extension Manager via Flatpak

```
flatpak install flathub com.mattjakeman.ExtensionManager
```

■ Press *Y* to confirm any prompts.

[2.2] Open Extension Manager

Go to your app grid → open Extension Manager → go to Browse tab.

[2.3] Install these extensions (search and enable each):

Extension Name	Purpose
Dash2Dock Animated	macOS-style dock at the bottom
Hot Edge	Hot corners like macOS Mission Control
User Themes	Allows custom GNOME shell themes
Hide Top Bar	Auto-hides the top panel

■ PHASE 3 — INSTALL ICON PACK

[3.1] Clone the MacTahoe icon theme

Use --depth=1 for faster download:

```
git clone --depth=1 https://github.com/vinceliuice/MacTahoe-icon-theme
```

[3.2] Install the icons

```
cd MacTahoe-icon-theme
```

```
./install.sh
```

■ *This installs icons to ~/.local/share/icons/*

■ PHASE 4 — INSTALL GTK THEME

[4.1] Clone the MacTahoe GTK theme

```
git clone --depth=1 https://github.com/vinceliuice/MacTahoe-gtk-theme
```

[4.2] Install the theme with macOS-style buttons

```
cd MacTahoe-gtk-theme
```

```
./install.sh -a alt --shell -i arch --round
```

Flag explanation:

Flag	What it does
-a alt	Enables macOS-style traffic light window buttons
--shell	Applies theme to GNOME shell panel
-i arch	Sets the Activities button icon to Arch logo
--round	Makes maximized windows have rounded corners

[4.3] Install theme for Libadwaita (GTK4 apps)

```
./install.sh -a alt --shell -i arch --round -l
```

■ *This makes modern GNOME apps (like Files) also use the theme.*

■ PHASE 5 — APPLY THE THEME

[5.1] Open GNOME Tweaks

Search 'Tweaks' in your app grid. Go to Appearance tab.

[5.2] Set these values in Appearance:

Setting	Value to Set
Icons	MacTahoe (or MacTahoe-dark)
Shell	MacTahoe-Dark-alt
Legacy Applications	MacTahoe-Dark-alt
Cursor	MacTahoe-dark (optional)

[5.3] Set window buttons to the LEFT (like macOS)

In Tweaks → Windows → Titlebar Buttons:

- Enable Minimize and Maximize
- Set Placement → Left

[5.4] Force button layout via terminal (backup method)

```
gsettings set org.gnome.desktop.wm.preferences button-layout  
'close,minimize,maximize:'
```

[5.5] Fix Flatpak apps to use the theme

```
sudo flatpak override --filesystem=xdg-config/gtk-3.0 && sudo flatpak override  
--filesystem=xdg-config/gtk-4.0
```

■ PHASE 6 — CONFIGURE DOCK & SYSTEM SETTINGS

[6.1] Configure Dash2Dock Animated

In Extension Manager → gear icon next to Dash2Dock Animated:

- Position → Bottom
- Icon size → 48–54px
- Enable Autohide
- Enable Dodge Windows

[6.2] Enable Hot Corners

Settings → Multitasking → turn ON Hot Corners

[6.3] Disable Edge Tiling (stops windows from snapping to sides)

Settings → Multitasking → turn OFF Edge Tiling

■ PHASE 7 — CUSTOM KEYBINDINGS (OPTIONAL)

Go to: Settings → Keyboard → View and Customize Shortcuts → Custom Shortcuts

Click + to add each one:

Shortcut	Command	Action
Super + Q	<code>wmctrl -c :ACTIVE:</code>	Close active window
Super + W	<code>google-chrome-stable</code>	Open Chrome
Super + A	<code>obsidian</code>	Open Obsidian
Super + E	<code>nautilus</code>	Open Files
Super + T	<code>kitty</code>	Open Terminal

■ PHASE 8 — CHROME TRAFFIC LIGHT BUTTONS

Chrome uses its own titlebar by default. To get GTK-style buttons:

[8.1] Open Chrome flags

```
chrome://flags/#ozone-platform-hint
```

Set it to: Wayland

[8.2] Enable system titlebar

Chrome menu (■) → Settings → Appearance → turn ON 'Use system title bar and borders'

[8.3] Fix white theme inside Chrome

Settings → Appearance → Theme → click Use Classic

Then set Mode → Dark

■ *Chrome won't show red/yellow/green colored buttons — that's a Chrome limitation. The buttons will be grey but functional on the left side.*

■ QUICK REFERENCE — ALL COMMANDS

Remove pacman lock

```
sudo rm /var/lib/pacman/db.lck
```

Install dependencies

```
sudo pacman -S gcc make cmake git curl wget wmctrl sassc gnome-tweaks
```

Install GNOME

```
sudo pacman -S gnome gnome-extra
```

Disable SDDM

```
sudo systemctl disable sddm
```

Enable GDM

```
sudo systemctl enable gdm
```

Install Ext Manager

```
flatpak install flathub com.mattjakeman.ExtensionManager
```

Clone icon theme

```
git clone --depth=1 https://github.com/vinceliuice/MacTahoe-icon-theme
```

Install icons

```
cd MacTahoe-icon-theme && ./install.sh
```

Clone GTK theme

```
git clone --depth=1 https://github.com/vinceliuice/MacTahoe-gtk-theme
```

Install GTK theme

```
cd MacTahoe-gtk-theme && ./install.sh -a alt --shell -i arch --round
```

Install for GTK4

```
./install.sh -a alt --shell -i arch --round -l
```

Fix button layout

```
gsettings set org.gnome.desktop.wm.preferences button-layout  
'close,minimize,maximize:'
```

Fix Flatpak theme

```
sudo flatpak override --filesystem=xdg-config/gtk-3.0 && sudo flatpak override  
--filesystem=xdg-config/gtk-4.0
```